It was in a semi-final too – in 2007 against the Aussies. We were already deep in the shit, with five wickets down for 27, and Shaun Tait was the bowler. I got a big inside edge to a Tait in-swinger that Adam Gilchrist, diving to his left, took cleanly. It was a clear nick, no doubt, but I was like, 'No. Why walk now? The match is already down the toilet. You might as well try to get a 100 while you're at the crease.'

For some reason umpire Steve Bucknor didn't give me out and, as you can expect from a pumped-up and competitive bunch like Ricky Ponting's men, they were not at all happy about it. All sorts of comments came flying my way. They were pissed off, obviously, but at least they weren't swearing. Probably only because they had us by the balls anyway … I was thinking, 'This is a World Cup, and if you stand your ground, you might get away with it.' Which I did. Not that it helped. As I already said, we got our butts kicked.

I don't know if you've noticed, but my long-term colleague, Jacques Kallis, is a genius at standing. He's a total expert at never looking back – a really tough skill to master, because 99 per cent of us automatically look behind us when we've nicked the ball. Jacques never changes his expression either. Old Jacques just loves batting so much that he's learnt to cover his mistakes very well.

Actually, I did too. It's a funny story. The exact dates are a little hazy, but I was playing for Western Province against Griquas in a final at Newlands. I remember Peter Kirsten was our coach. Griquas batted first and didn't get too much. The total looked very gettable – the only problem was that it had been raining on and off. Before going out to bat, I remember Kirzie saying, 'Hersch, it rained on the way here … We are not going to lose this game because of the damn rain.' I said, 'Cool,' and went out and played some shots. Some serious shots, as I recall.

Lloyd Ferreira and I were going great guns when, on 49, I got the biggest nick. It was a *huge* deflection. I think the keeper caught the ball in front of first slip. I just stood there thinking, 'The rain is on the way. I've got to finish this game!'

Fortunately umpire Rudi Koertzen was of the same opinion, and he just shook his head and said in that firm, square-jawed voice of his, 'Not out! *Nee man, ons moet nou die game klaarkry*!' It was really funny. I don't think the Griquas okes were even too upset about it.